

Microsoft's MAI-Image-1, its first image-gen model



Microsoft has unveiled MAI-Image-1, its first image generation model developed entirely in-house. According to the tech giant, this new model ranks among the top 10 text-to-image models on LMArena. According to Microsoft and initial reports, the MAI-Image-1 model is said to generate photorealistic images, including lighting and landscapes, faster and more efficiently than with many larger models out there. Interesting development. tinyurl.com/2kj8k4ch

Google rolls out its no-code AI mini-app builder in India



Initially, Google expected users to build simple and fun apps, but the response was far beyond expectations. Early users created sophisticated, practical, and highly creative apps, showing the huge potential of Opal. If you want to try Opal, you can visit opal.withgoogle.com. "Whether you're automating a complex business process, accelerating your marketing efforts or bringing a creative vision to life, Opal is here to help you build," the tech giant said in a blogpost. tinyurl.com/24hynpu9

What is Compound AI

Check out key features of this finance AI spreadsheet tool

—By **Vyom Ramani**

Enter Compound AI, a groundbreaking browser-based platform launched in beta on October 15, 2025, by Twenty Labs. Billed as the "world's first AI Analyst for finance you can trust," Compound redefines spreadsheet workflows by combining AI's speed with the auditability that finance pros demand. Built by a team of ex-Google DeepMind and Coatue Management veterans, it's designed for deal teams craving accuracy without the black-box risks.

At its core, Compound operates as an AI-native workspace, ingesting vast datasets, from hulking S-1 PDFs to customer CSVs, and spitting out Excel-compatible spreadsheets in minutes. Users prompt it naturally ("Build a three-year projection for Robinhood"), and it delivers traceable results with citations to sources. Early buzz looks promising.

Interactive spreadsheets

Gone are the days of static AI summaries. Compound's browser-based interface mirrors Excel, letting users dive

into outputs with full interactivity. Tweak assumptions, like doubling growth rates in a pro forma model, and watch ripple effects update in real time. As demoed in the launch video, it crafts a TAM model for the U.S. airline industry from a blank sheet in under five minutes, complete with dummy data and forecasts.



Formula tracing previews every calculation, ensuring outputs feel native to your workflow. This isn't just generation; it's co-creation, bridging AI's power with human oversight for seamless iteration.

Infinite workspace

Finance data deluges are no match for Compound's "infinite context." Upload thousands of documents, Excel sheets, image-heavy filings like Figma's S-1, or entire data rooms, and the AI scans

them holistically, surfacing relevant snippets without manual hunting. It recommends analyses on upload, such as integrated contribution models from scattered financials. This feature shines in due diligence, where querying "Extract revenue trends from customer logs" pulls from disparate files instantly.

Full Excel compatibility

Integration is king, and Compound delivers with robust file support. Outputs export as .xlsx or .csv, fully forward- and backward-compatible with Microsoft Excel – no reformatting headaches. Upcoming .xlsm and .xlsb formats will unlock macros and binaries, while multi-workbook editing lets you chain analyses across sheets.

Auditable analysis

Trust is non-negotiable in finance, and Compound embeds it deeply. Every cell cites sources, hyperlinked to PDF pages or data points, with a "review changes" pane logging AI steps from extraction to computation. Restore checkpoints or save versions effortlessly, minimizing errors in audits. AES-256 encryption secures data. tinyurl.com/2bdvas79